



Inside the **nonprofit AI divide.**

Jennifer Hu and Ryan Chan

What 930 nonprofit respondents told us

586

work at organizations of 15 or
fewer staff

15%

of respondents consider
themselves AI skeptics

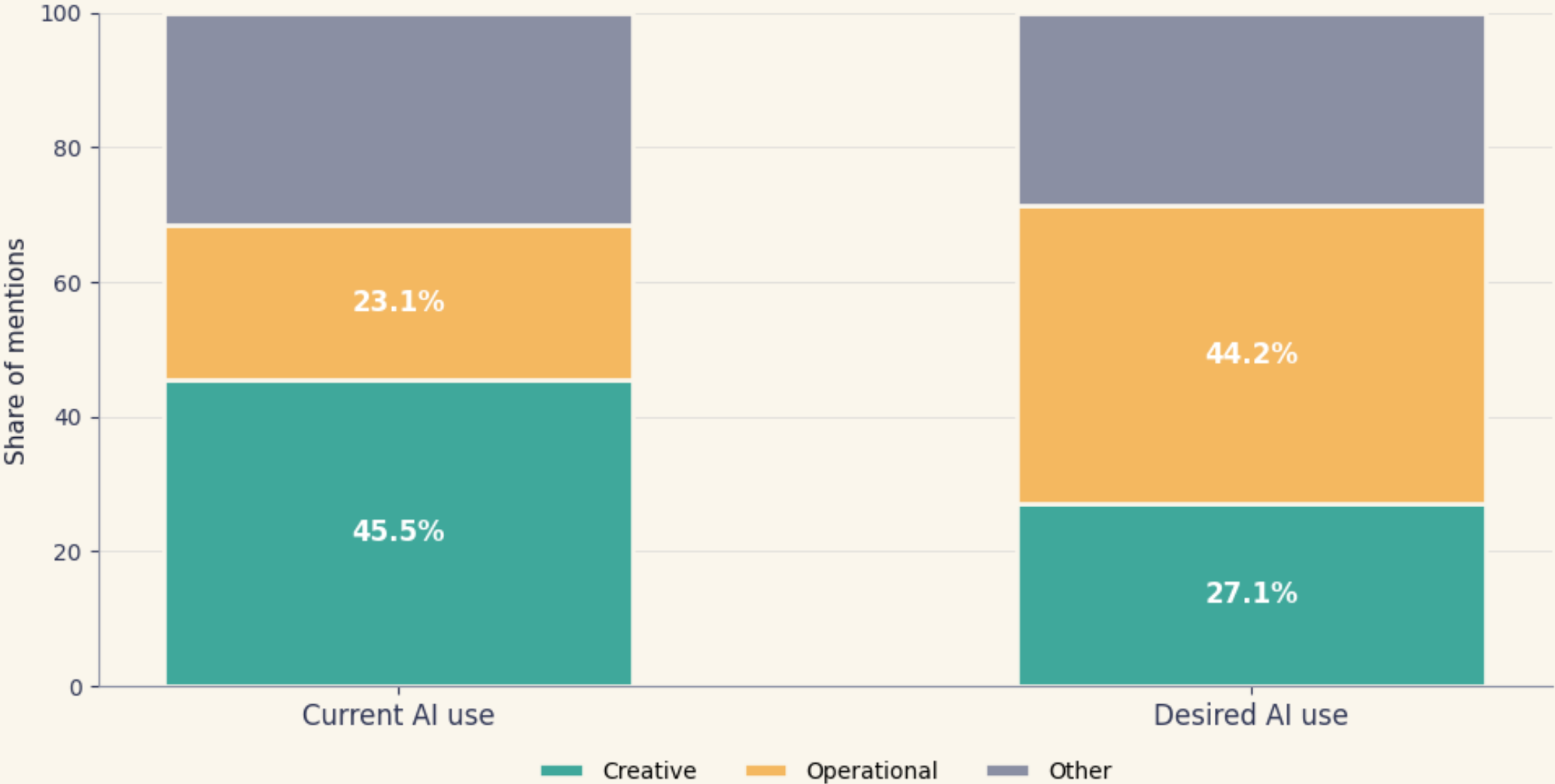
62%

of current AI use is
creative work

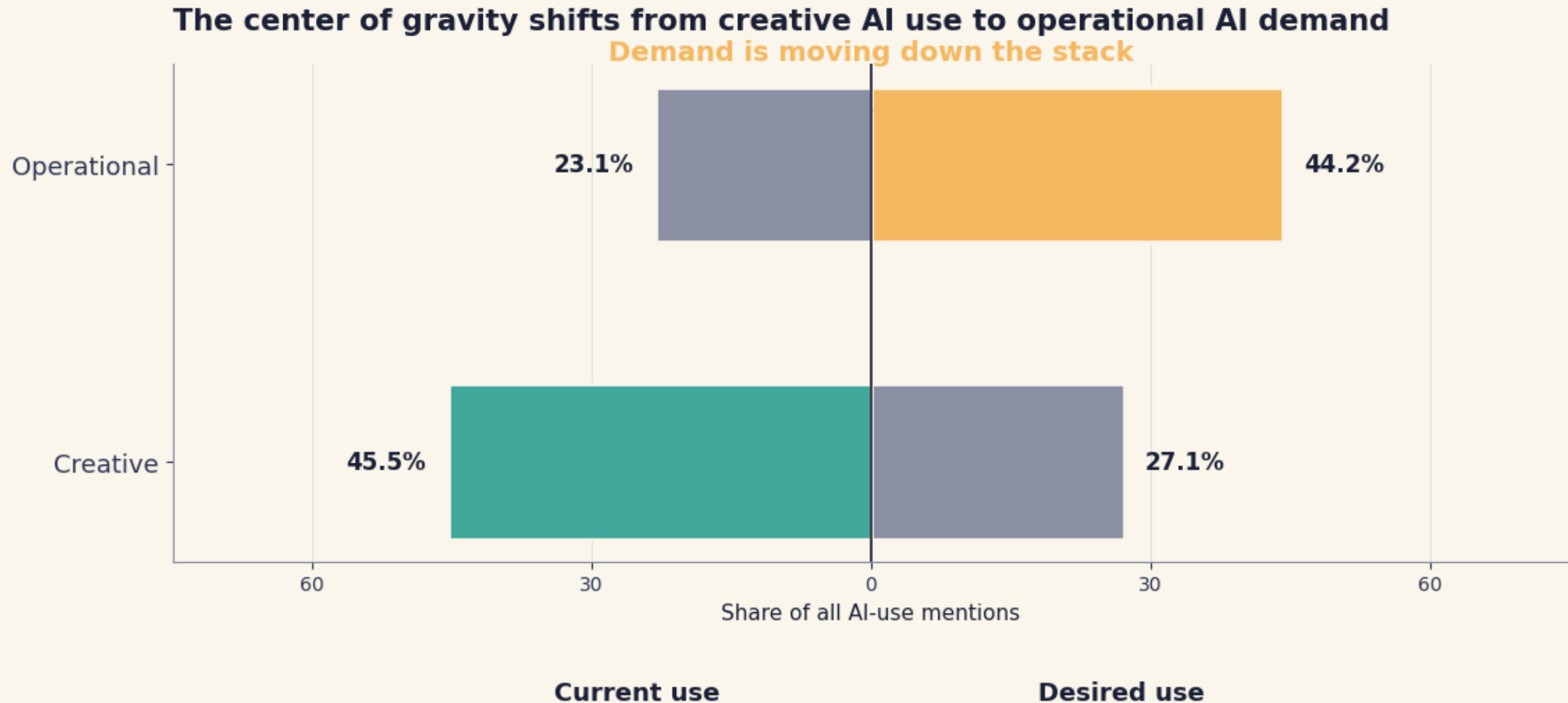
60%

of stated demand
is operational

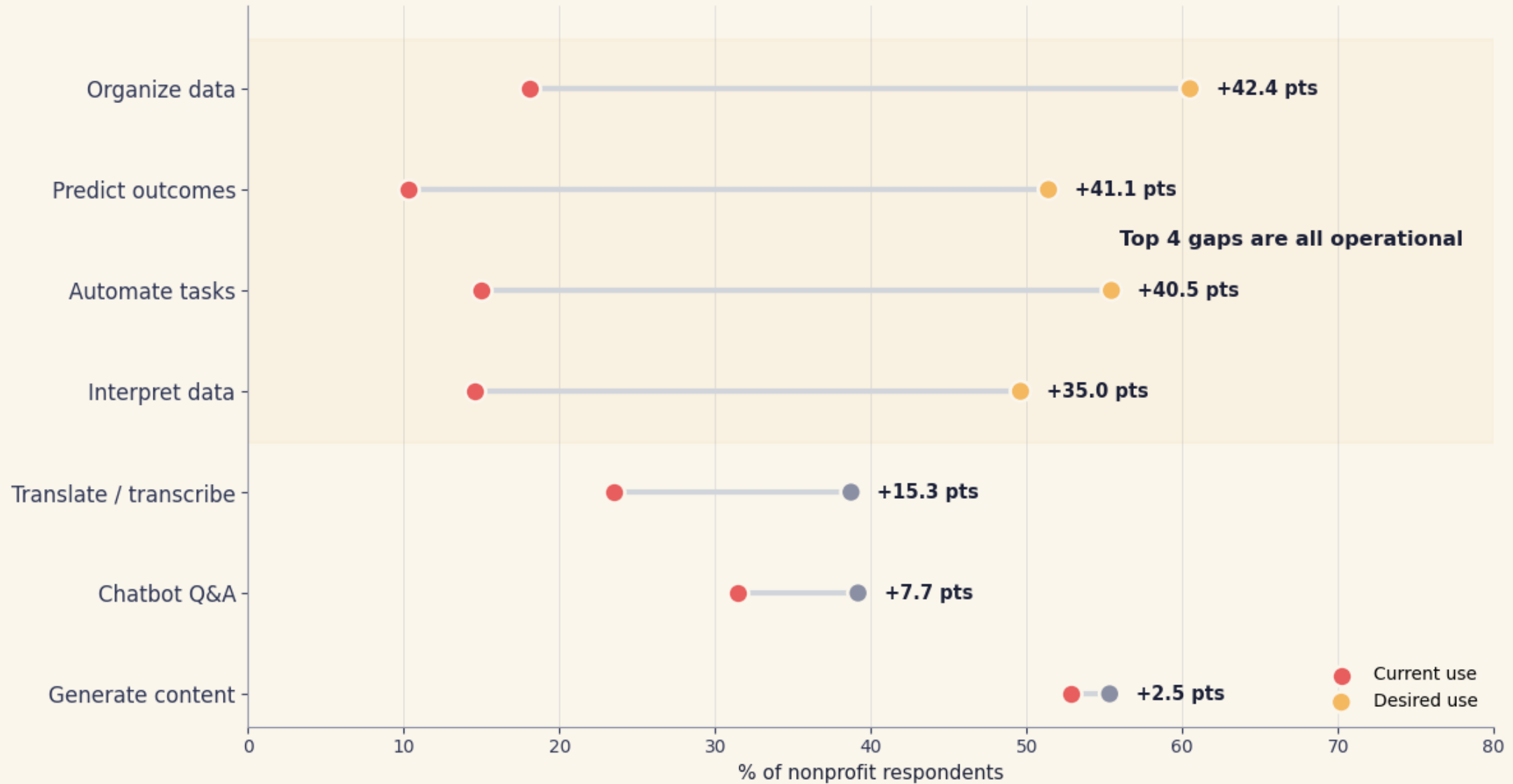
The shape of demand changes, not just the amount of it



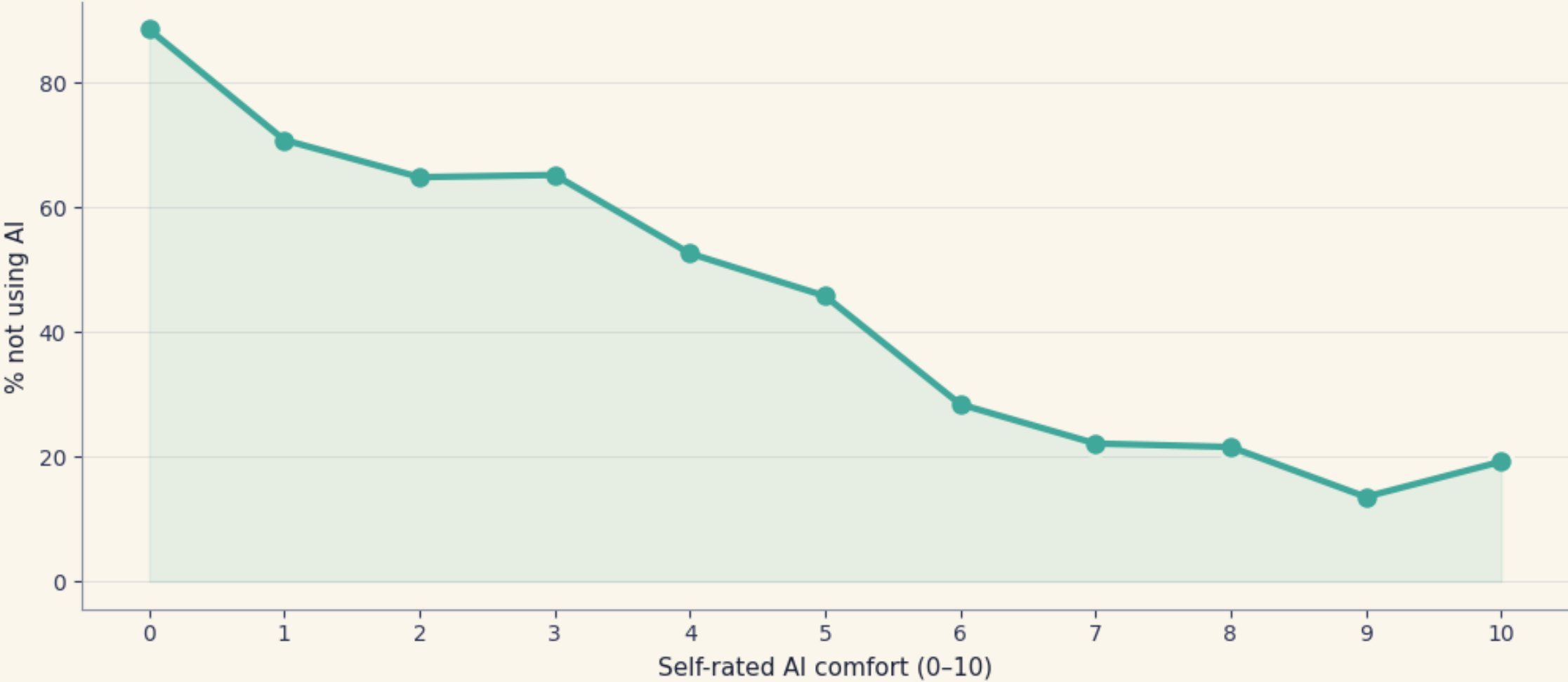
Operational AI dominates demand

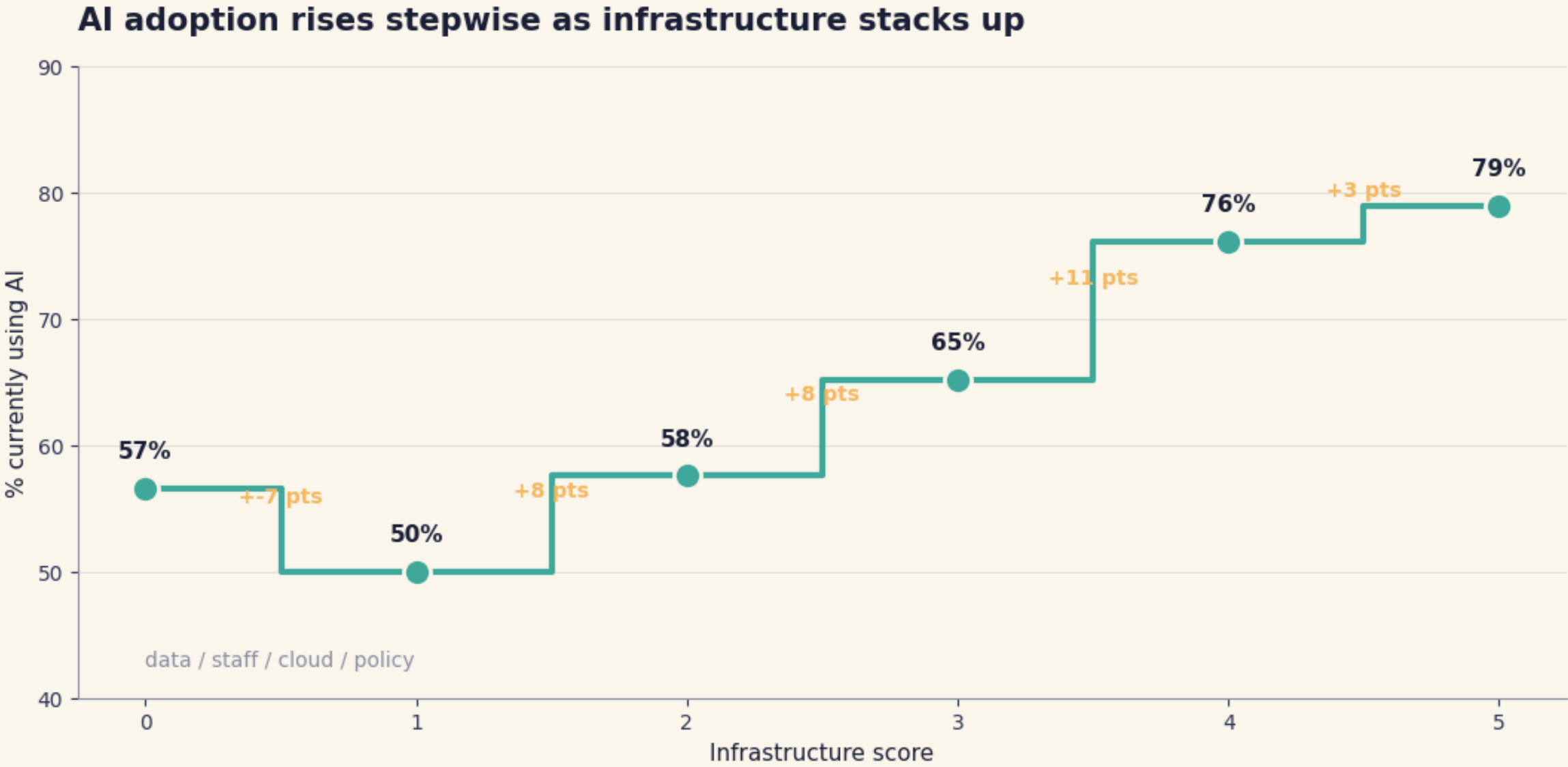


The biggest unmet demand is operational AI work



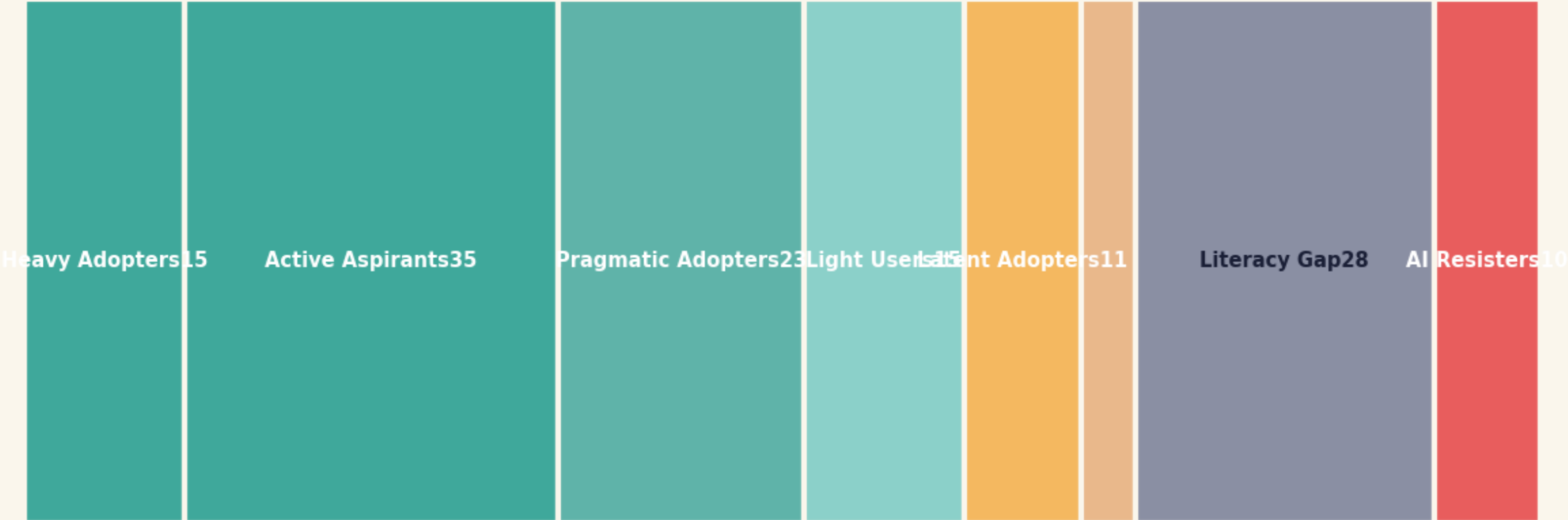
Comfort still matters, but it behaves like a curve, not a cliff





The "AI Skeptic" cluster isn't really skeptical

The published "AI Skeptic" cluster actually contains many different behaviors



93%

of the "skeptical" cluster is mislabeled

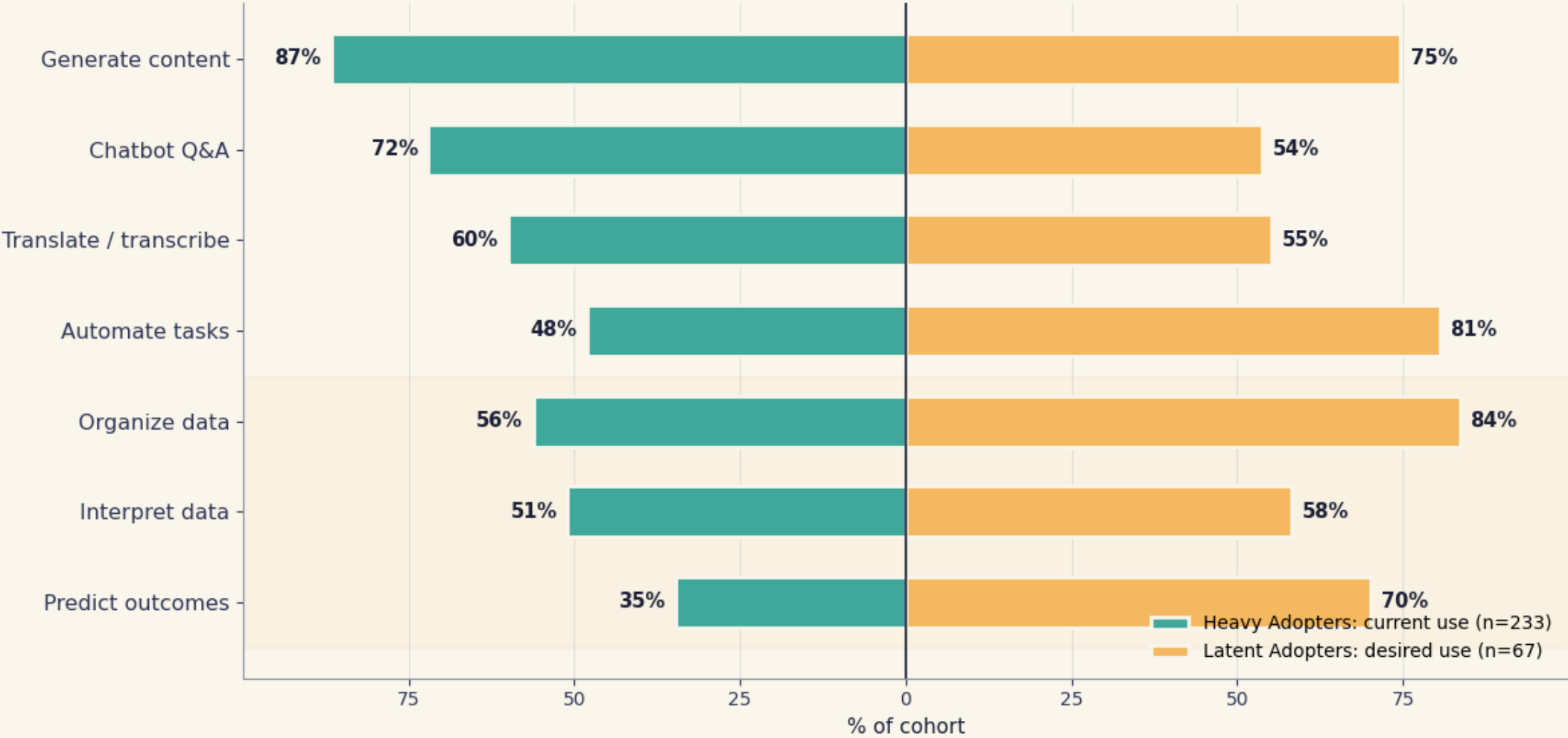
16%

fall into the Literacy Gap cohort

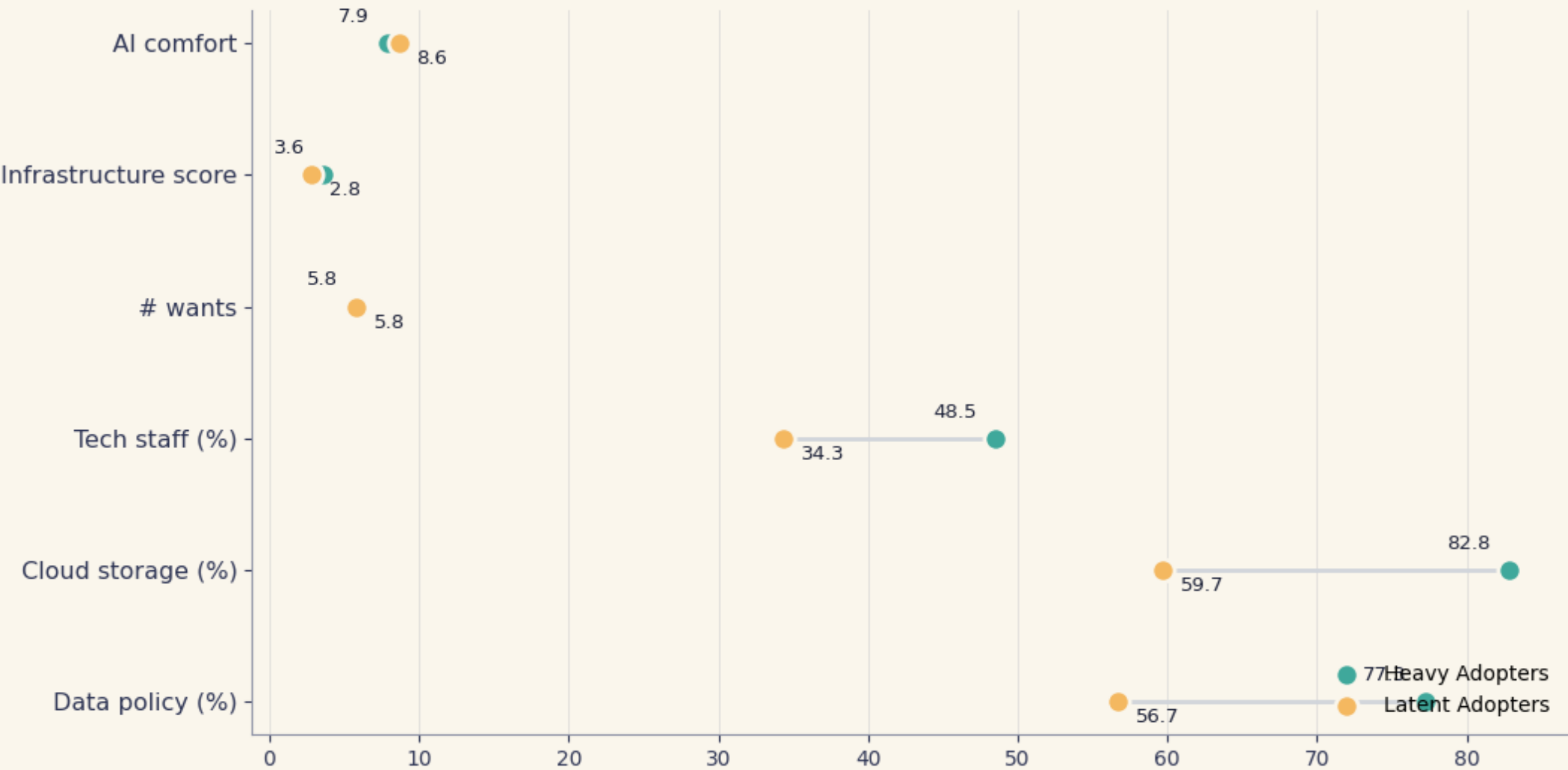
4%

are true AI Resisters

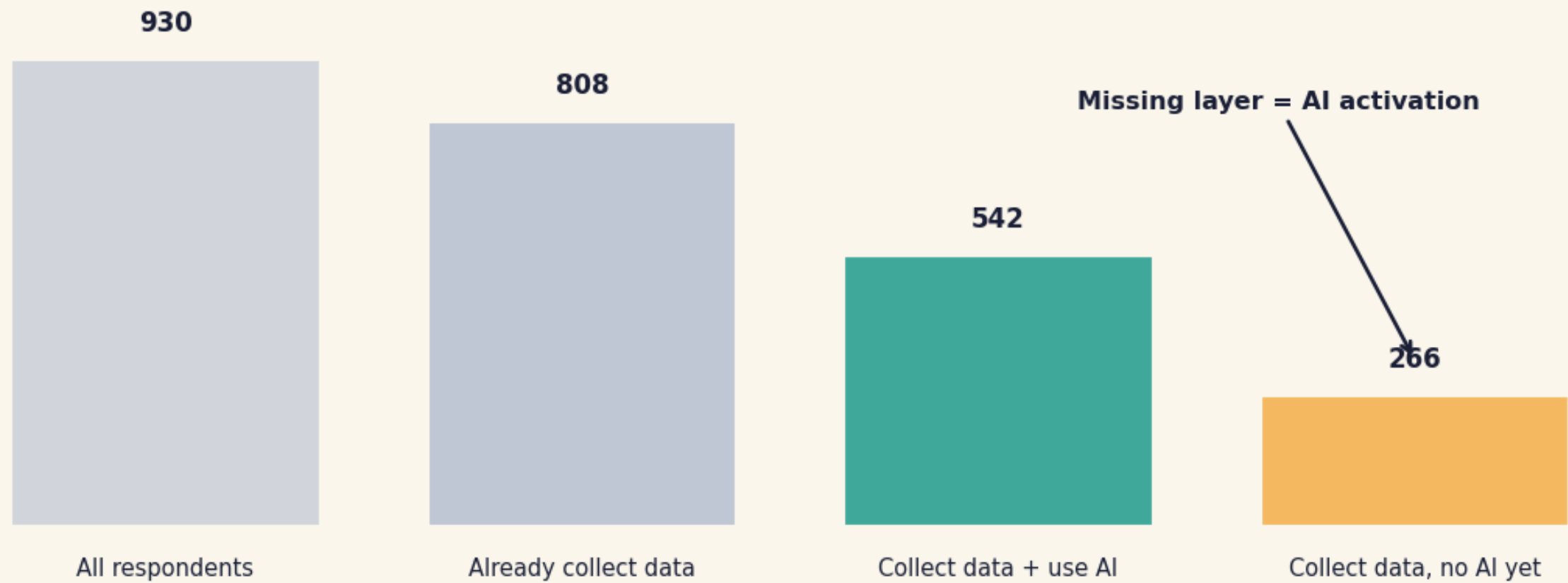
Today's adopters are creative-heavy; latent demand is operational-heavy



Latent adopters are not confused; they look partly ready



The near-term opportunity is not persuasion. It is activation.



Delivery into the operational tier.

01

The bottleneck is infrastructure, not ideology

True AI Resisters are 4% of the sample. The constraint is data, staff, cloud, and policy, not attitude.

02

The next wave of demand is operational

60% of stated demand is for organizing, automating, predicting. The first wave's consumer tools don't ship that.

03

The activation pool is already there

Tens of thousands of nonprofits have full demand yet only partial infrastructure.